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DOCUMENT 1: AI ACT OVERVIEW

Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 - Artificial Intelligence Act

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1. WHAT IS THE AI ACT?

The EU AI Act (Regulation EU 2024/1689) is the world's first comprehensive legal framework for artificial intelligence. Adopted on 13 June 2024 and published in the Official Journal on 12 July 2024, it establishes harmonised rules for the development, placing on the market, putting into service, and use of AI systems in the European Union.

Its core objectives are:

- Ensure AI systems are safe, transparent, and respect fundamental rights
- Create a uniform legal framework across the EU internal market
- Promote trustworthy, human-centric AI
- Prevent fragmentation of national rules
- Foster innovation while managing risks

2. WHO DOES IT APPLY TO?

The AI Act applies to:

PROVIDERS: Any natural or legal person, public authority, agency or body that develops an AI system or a general-purpose AI model and places it on the market or puts it into service under their own name or trademark, whether for payment or free of charge.

DEPLOYERS: Any natural or legal person, public authority, agency or body using an AI system under their authority, except when used in the course of

a personal non-professional activity.

IMPORTERS: Persons established in the EU that place on the market an AI system bearing the name or trademark of a natural or legal person established outside the EU.

DISTRIBUTORS: Persons in the supply chain making an AI system available on the EU market.

3. TERRITORIAL SCOPE

The AI Act applies to:

- Providers established in the EU or a third country if the AI system output is intended to be used in the EU
- Deployers established or located in the EU
- Providers and deployers established in third countries when the output produced by their AI systems is used in the EU

EXCLUSIONS from scope:

- AI systems used exclusively for military, defence, or national security
- AI systems developed solely for scientific research and development
- AI systems used by public authorities of third countries under international cooperation agreements (with adequate safeguards)
- Personal non-professional use

4. IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

ENTRY INTO FORCE: 1 August 2024

(20 days after publication on 12 July 2024)

AUGUST 2025 (12 months after entry into force):

- Chapter I (General Provisions) and Chapter II (Prohibited Practices) become applicable
- Prohibited AI practices (Article 5) are BANNED as of this date
- Key date for: banning of unacceptable risk AI systems

AUGUST 2026 (24 months after entry into force):

- The majority of the regulation becomes applicable
- High-risk AI system obligations (Article 6 + Annex III) apply
- General-purpose AI model rules apply
- Governance and market surveillance provisions apply
- Key date for: compliance obligations for high-risk AI providers and deployers

AUGUST 2027 (36 months after entry into force):

- Full enforcement including high-risk AI systems embedded in regulated products (Annex I) — e.g. medical devices, machinery, vehicles
- Key date for: complete enforcement across all product categories

ADDITIONAL SPECIFIC DATE:

- 2 August 2025: EU AI Office and AI Board operational rules apply
- 2 August 2026: Codes of practice for general-purpose AI models finalized

5. KEY INSTITUTIONS

- EUROPEAN AI OFFICE: Central EU body overseeing general-purpose AI models and coordinating enforcement
- EUROPEAN AI BOARD: Composed of national supervisory authorities, advises on consistent implementation
- NATIONAL COMPETENT AUTHORITIES: Each Member State designates at least one authority responsible for enforcement

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Source: Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 of the European Parliament and of the
Council of 13 June 2024. OJ L, 2024/1689, 12.7.2024.

ELI: <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1689/oj>

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